and Delhi Cantt. But more than the physical location of the Dtes, the real issue was of their functioning and inter-Dte coordination.

The Chief has a number of Principal Staff Officers of the rank of Lt Gen to assist him, starting with the VCOAS and two DCOAS. The other PSOs are the DGMO, DGMI, DGMT, AG, QMG, MGO, MS, Engineer-in-Chief and Signals Officer-in-Chief. When I took over as Chief, there were two DCOAS, a DCOAS (IS&T) looking after Information Systems and Training, and a DCOAS (MP&S) for Manpower, Planning and Services. Apart from the DGMO and DGMI who reported directly to the VCOAS/COAS, all the other PSOs reported to one or the other of the DCOAS. Thus, for example, while the DGMT reported to the DCOAS (IS&T), the AG reported to the DCOAS (MP&S).[20] This was also the organization at the time of the Doklam crisis of 2017 when Gen Bipin Rawat was the Chief.

In responding to the crisis, Gen Rawat realized that the Dtes seemed to be working in isolation. The DGMO and DGMI, for example, would often have different inputs or even different interpretations of the same input. The DGPP, responsible for Perspective Planning and drawing up the LTPP based on which future acquisitions towards capability-building are made, reported to the DCOAS (IS&T). The MGO, responsible for the sustenance of the force and capabilities built up, however, reported to the DCOAS (MP&S). It was not an ideal situation, with the result that the Chief was not getting a composite picture, or 'completed staff work' as it is known in Army parlance. Accordingly, Gen Rawat tasked the then DGFP, Lt Gen Ajai Singh to work on a new model to streamline the working of the various Dtes.[21] Ajai set to work and made a number of models, taking inputs from the various PSOs

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